MONTHLY UPDATE

Niger: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16-2 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.

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DRAFT ORDINANCE ON THE ELECTRONIC PRESS

- **Conclusions du Conseil des ministres du jeudi 10 septembre 2026** — Gouvernement du Niger, 10 September 2026

  Niger's Council of Ministers adopted on 10 September 2026 a draft ordinance creating a legal regime for the electronic press and a draft decree on press correspondents and accreditation of foreign media. The government said online media had lacked a legal framework, preventing the communication observatory ONC from regulating them. The decree gives the ONC an opinion on foreign-correspondent accreditation.

- **Niger's Media Adjustment: Regulation, Control, and the Shrinking Newsroom in the Sahel** — ModernGhana, 15 September 2026

  The council of ministers approved an overhaul of the media regulatory framework on 10 September, tightening accreditation for foreign correspondents and carrying a draft ordinance requiring online press publishers to be identified, with legal responsibility on digital newsrooms for what they carry.

ARRETE ON COMMERCIAL WI-FI ZONE PROVISION

- **Le CFAIC plaide pour une réglementation adaptée aux réalités des Wifi Zones au Niger - Agence Nigérienne de Presse** — Agence Nigérienne de Presse, 20 September 2026

Niger's collective of community internet access providers (CFAIC-Niger) called on 20 September 2026 for Wi-Fi Zone rules that operators can realistically meet. It welcomed the order placing Wi-Fi Zones under a declaration regime but contested provisions on equipment, file-review fees, annual royalties and technical limits, and asked for six months to comply.

Regional collaboration

PLATFORM OF AES MEDIA AND COMMUNICATION REGULATORS (PAREMEC)

- **AES : Création à Niamey d'une plateforme des régulateurs des médias et communication de l'espace communautaire** — Agence Nigérienne de Presse, 17 September 2026

  Media and communication regulators from the Alliance of Sahel States met in Niamey on 17–18 September 2026 for the constitutive conference of a joint regulators' platform, on the theme of informational sovereignty and countering disinformation. Niger's communication ministry said the platform should share expertise and set up a common monitoring and alert mechanism on information threats.

- **Fin des travaux de l'assemblée générale constitutive des régulateurs de la communication AES: Le Malien Coulibaly Gaoussou devient le 1er président de la plateforme - Agence Nigérienne de Presse** — Agence Nigérienne de Presse, 18 September 2026

  Media and communication regulators of the Alliance of Sahel States founded a joint platform, PAREMEC, at a constitutive assembly in Niamey that closed on 18 September 2026, with its seat in Niamey and Mali's communication authority head Coulibaly Gaoussou as first president. Recommendations to governments included laws regulating traditional and digital media, tools to monitor digital content, and a common approach to digital platforms.

COOPERATION CONVENTION OF THE CONFEDERATION TELECOMMUNICATIONS REGULATORS (CONSEIL DES RÉGULATEURS DU SAHEL)

- **Coopération régionale entre les régulateurs de l'AES : Signature d'une convention de coopération le 25 septembre 2026 à Ouagadougou** — leFaso.net (communiqué of ARCEP Burkina Faso), 23 September 2026 BURKINA FASO MALI WEST AFRICA

  The telecoms regulators of Burkina Faso, Mali and Niger are to sign a cooperation agreement in Ouagadougou on 25 September creating a Sahel Regulators' Council. It covers roaming within the Alliance of Sahel States, consumer protection, cybersecurity, spectrum, mutual recognition of type-approved equipment and joint positions in international bodies.

- **Espace AES : Les régulateurs des télécommunications créent le Conseil des régulateurs du Sahel** — leFaso.net, 26 September 2026 BURKINA FASO MALI WEST AFRICA

  The telecoms regulators of Burkina Faso, Mali and Niger signed a convention creating the Conseil des régulateurs du Sahel, reported on 26 September 2026. Its priorities include harmonised regulation, consumer protection, coordinated infrastructure and tariffs, with work on border frequency coordination, free roaming across the three states and coordinated 5G. Statutes are still to be adopted; no signing date is given.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

MEDIA AND PLATFORM MONITORING AFTER THE EVENTS OF 28-29 AUGUST 2026

- **Medias : Ameliorer l''ecosysteme de l''information et de la communication en temps de crise au centre d''une rencontre a Niamey** — Agence Nigerienne de Presse (ANP), 2 September 2026

Niger's communications minister Adji Ali Salatou and the national communication observatory (ONC) met media chiefs in Niamey on 2 September 2026 after the events of 28-29 August at the capital's air base. The ONC presented its monitoring of broadcast, online and platform content from 28 August to 1 September, citing an information vacuum, conflicting descriptions of the events and disinformation on social networks.

- **Rencontre entre le ministre charge de la Communication, le president de l''ONC et les promoteurs de medias : l''ONC devoile les conclusions d''un monitoring** — Le Sahel (ONEP), 3 September 2026

  Niger's national communication observatory (ONC) presented its monitoring of coverage of the 28-29 August 2026 events in Niamey to media owners on 2 September, alongside the communications minister. It found intense information demand, an information vacuum, official and international media describing the events differently, and old images and out-of-context video circulating on social networks.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

ALGÉRIE TÉLÉCOM CONVENTIONS WITH NIGER TELECOM AND THE NATIONAL TELECOMS SCHOOL

- **Cooperation : Algerie Telecom signe deux conventions de partenariat avec Niger Telecom et ESCEP-Niger** — Agence Nigerienne de Presse, 8 September 2026 ALGERIA

  Algérie Télécom signed agreements in Niamey on 8 September 2026 with Niger Télécom and Niger's telecoms and postal school ESCEP-Niger. They cover a skills centre at the school, training for Niger Télécom staff, and donated transmission equipment for a fibre link between Ngezam and Agadez with an initial 100 Gbps capacity on Niger Télécom's national backbone. No value is given.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

OPERATOR PROMOTIONAL DATA TARIFFS

- **Avec 500F bénéficiez de 3.5Go de 23H à 06H pour naviguer en toute sérénité** — Moov Africa Niger, 1 September 2026

  Moov Africa Niger advertised a night-time mobile data bundle of 3.5GB for 500 CFA francs, usable from 23:00 to 06:00 and activated by dialling *1577#*, in a LinkedIn post on 1 September 2026. That is about 143 CFA francs per gigabyte.

MOBILE NETWORK SERVICE QUALITY

- **L'air du temps : Le reseau mobile : mauvaise qualite et desarroi des usagers** — Le Sahel (ONEP), 4 September 2026

  Niger's electronic communications and post regulator launched a campaign on 27 July to verify mobile network coverage and the voice and data service map. A press account reports users facing poor quality for several months - interrupted calls, correspondents shown as unavailable or engaged - with the regulator's expert findings still awaited.

IN GUEZZAM TO ARLIT-AGADEZ FIBRE LINK WITH ALGERIA

- **Coopération Niger-Algérie : arrivée du ministre Hamani Kargné à Agadez pour le lancement des travaux d'interconnexion par fibre optique** — Ministère de la Communication et des Nouvelles Technologies de l'Information (Niger), 6 October 2026 ALGERIA

Niger's communications ministry reported its minister's arrival at Agadez on 5 October with an Algerian delegation, describing the mission as the launch of fibre interconnection works between the two countries; the ceremony itself is summarised above.

- **L'Algérie et le Niger lancent l'exploitation de la dorsale transsaharienne à fibre optique** — Algérie Eco (reporting Algérie Presse Service), 6 October 2026 ALGERIA

  The Algerian account of the Assamaka ceremony, summarised above, says the link was built by Algerie Telecom and Niger Telecom, starts at 100 Gbps and can be expanded as traffic grows.

- **Niger-Algérie : lancement à Assamaka de l'exploitation de la dorsale transsaharienne à fibre optique** — Agence Nigérienne de Presse, 6 October 2026 ALGERIA

  Niger and Algeria launched operation of the fibre link between In Guezzam and the Arlit-Agadez region at a ceremony at Assamaka, on the border, on 6 October, chaired by the two communications ministers. Algeria's account gives a starting capacity of 100 Gbps.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

AGENCE NATIONALE DE L'ENREGISTREMENT ET DE L'IDENTIFICATION DES PERSONNES PHYSIQUES

- **Diffa : lancement de la tournee nationale de sensibilisation sur la modernisation de l''etat civil et l''identification** — Agence Nigerienne de Presse (ANP), 3 September 2026

  Niger opened a national awareness tour on civil registration, identification and the modernisation of the national identification system at Diffa on 3 September 2026. The opening workshop, chaired by the regional secretary-general, briefed institutional and community actors on reforms carried out under the World Bank-supported WURI-Niger unique identification project.

AES BIOMETRIC PASSPORT

- **Niger : l'enrôlement pour le passeport biométrique AES débute le 15 septembre 2026** — NigerDiaspora, 9 September 2026

  Niger's interior ministry said mass enrolment for the Alliance of Sahel States biometric passport opens on 15 September 2026, at the territorial surveillance directorate in Niamey and regional police offices elsewhere. The passport costs 45,000 FCFA, or 29,750 FCFA for minors and students. Passports bearing the ECOWAS logo stay valid until they expire.

- **From ECOWAS to AES: Niger Completes Its Passport Break with the Regional Bloc** — ModernGhana, 11 September 2026

  Niger launched its own biometric passport, with President Abdourahamane Tiani enrolled first, making it the last of the three Alliance of Sahel States members to replace the ECOWAS passport. The system has five categories, including a hajj passport, and the Libyan firm Al Itissan Al-Jadeed is involved in production. Existing ECOWAS passports remain valid.

- **Lancement officiel du passeport biométrique AES : le Niger se dote d'un nouveau document de voyage aux normes internationales** — ActuNiger, 16 September 2026

  Niger opened mass enrolment for the Sahel confederation's biometric passport in Niamey on 15 September 2026, with enrolment kits to go to every region and the diaspora. An ordinary passport costs 45,000 FCFA and runs five years, with online pre-enrolment through mobile money services.

AES BIOMETRIC NATIONAL IDENTITY CARD

- **CNIB AES à Agadez : Tarifs, pièces et enrôlement** — Journal du Niger, 15 September 2026

  Enrolment for the regional bloc's biometric national identity card opened in Agadez at the regional police headquarters, fingerprints and biometric parameters collected locally and processed centrally.

AES BIOMETRIC PASSPORT

- **Niger begins operational rollout of AES biometric passport** — Biometric Update, 18 September 2026

  Niger opened public enrolment for the Alliance of Sahel States biometric passport in Niamey on 15 September, with regional and diaspora centres and online pre-enrolment through mobile money to follow. An ordinary passport costs FCFA 45,000; Niger is the last of the three states to issue it.

Digital Payments and Fintech

MOBILE-MONEY PAYMENT AT THE VEHICLE ONE-STOP SHOP

- **Guichet Unique Automobile: SONILOGA ouvre le paiement de ses prestations à Airtel Money** — ActuNiger, 2 October 2026

  The operator of Niger's vehicle one-stop shop began accepting Airtel Money for some of its services on 1 October, through an app or an offline USSD code. The transport ministry presented it as a way to trace public revenue.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SECURE GOVERNMENT INTRANET

- **Ministère de la Communication et des NTI : le nouveau ministre Hamani Kargné officiellement installé** — ActuNiger, 24 September 2026

  Hamani Kargné took office as Niger's Minister of Communication and New Information Technologies at a handover ceremony on 22 September 2026, succeeding Adji Ali Salatou. His stated priorities include digitising public services through a secure government intranet, narrowing the digital divide between rural areas and towns, supporting start-ups and cybersecurity.

Capacity

Literacy

NATIONAL CAMPAIGN AGAINST DISINFORMATION

- **Citoyenneté numérique et paix : Lancement à Tillabéry de la 1ère Campagne nationale de lutte contre la désinformation** — MCNTI (Niger), 22 September 2026

  Niger's first national campaign against disinformation, under the slogan 'Check before you share', was launched in Tillabéry on 19 September 2026. It was organised by the NGO Jeunesse Plus with the support of the communication ministry, whose secretary-general presided. The campaign combines online awareness with media and information literacy workshops for local communities.

Training and skills

DIGITAL SKILLS CENTRE PARTNERSHIP WITH ALGERIA

- **Cooperation Niger Telecom - Algerie Telecom : Un partenariat pour renforcer les capacites des infrastructures telecoms du Niger** — Le Sahel, 9 September 2026 ALGERIA

> Niger's telecoms and post college ESCEP signed a convention with Algérie Télécom's Skills Centers network in Niamey on 8 September 2026, at a meeting chaired by the communication ministry's secretary-general. The agreement provides for a Skills Center at ESCEP with Algérie Télécom's support, aimed at training and the capacity of Niger's telecoms infrastructure. No cost is given.

- **Cooperation Niger - Algerie : Une delegation algerienne visite l'ESCEP dans le cadre d'un partenariat axe sur le numerique** — Le Sahel, 10 September 2026 ALGERIA

  Niger's telecommunications and post college received an Algerian mission led by the adviser for partnership and development of that country's operator skills-centre network. The visit follows a partnership accord of July aimed at establishing a digital competence centre, and is presented as reflecting the two heads of state's intent.

Inclusion

Access to services

NIGER DIGITAL DAY SKILLS CARAVAN

- **Diffa : Le Niger Digital Day renforce les competences numeriques des jeunes** — Agence Nigerienne de Presse (ANP), 3 September 2026

  Niger Digital Day, a digital-skills caravan touring Niger's eight regions, ran a two-day training for about sixty young people at the University of Diffa from 3 September 2026. The university's rector opened the session, which covered digital tools, jobs and opportunities, including AI-based tools.

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